Nepal earthquake of 2015, severe earthquake that struck near the city of Kathmandu in central Nepal on April 25, 2015. About 9,000 people were killed, many thousands more were injured, and more than 600,000 structures in Kathmandu and other nearby towns were either damaged or destroyed. The earthquake was felt throughout central and eastern Nepal, much of the Ganges River plain in northern India, and northwestern Bangladesh, as well as in the southern parts of the Plateau of Tibet and western Bhutan.

Technology in Action — The 2015 Nepal Earthquake

The devastating earthquake that struck Nepal on April 25, 2015, with a magnitude of 7.8, was a turning point in how technology was used in disaster response.

Use of Drones

In the immediate aftermath, drones were deployed to:

- **Map damaged areas** in Kathmandu and remote villages.
- Provide **aerial imagery** to identify collapsed buildings and blocked roads.
- Help rescue teams **prioritize areas** for relief and medical aid.

These unmanned aerial vehicles proved especially useful in **hard-to-reach mountainous regions**, where traditional ground surveys were impossible.

Role of Social Media

Social media platforms like Facebook and Twitter became lifelines:

- People used them to **report missing persons**, share their locations, and request help.
- Facebook activated its **"Safety Check"** feature, allowing users in the affected area to mark themselves safe.
- Volunteers and NGOs used hashtags like **#NepalQuake** to coordinate relief efforts and donations.

This real-time, crowd-sourced information helped authorities and humanitarian agencies **respond faster and more effectively**.